

Error handling refers to writing code that anticipates errors that are likely to occur and then responds to those errors.

To run successfully, a program needs the correct set of inputs and the ability to do its work, and it must return its output appropriately. Errors can happen during any of these stages. Well-written programs have error-handling code that anticipates and deals with errors that might occur at each stage.

Error handling can just be code that checks certain values and conditions before proceeding. If the values and conditions are appropriate, execution continues along one path. If not, it follows a different path.

One common approach is to check whether input is in the correct format. When a user inputs their age, you expect a positive number. You can add code to check for a positive number before continuing and then raise an exception if anything else is entered. An *exception* is a special error condition that responds to a specific kind of error.